



Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·
Gallagher Park

Sat, Aug 1, 2026 · 9:42 PM MDT

For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

4.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)
Forecast Sat 11:00 PM: **3.7**

Health Risk	AQHI	At-Risk Population	General Population
Moderate Risk	4.0	Consider reducing or rescheduling strenuous activities outdoors if you are experiencing symptoms.	No need to modify your usual outdoor activities unless you experience symptoms such as coughing and throat irritation.

Active Environment Canada Alerts

Severe Thunderstorm Watch — City of Edmonton - St. Albert - Sherwood Park

Wind Warning — City of Edmonton - St. Albert - Sherwood Park

Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 21.0°C and feels near 22.1°C. Winds are 11 km/h from NW, gusting near 23 km/h.
- Environment Canada has 2 active alert(s) in effect for the venue: severe thunderstorm watch, wind warning.
- The nearest current AQHI is 4 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- The official Government of Alberta AQHI for Edmonton is 4 (forecast tonight: 5, tomorrow: 3).
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 3.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM_{2.5}) at 34.3 µg/m³.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA_CloverdaleCL', 0.5 km) reads 33.6 µg/m³ PM_{2.5}.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 101.1 km to the S, i.e. arriving from the S.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-08-01) is 6.0 km E of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory passes within 6.0 km of this fire, making smoke transport to the venue plausible based on wind-field modeling.
- The AQHI forecast for Sat 11:00 PM is 4.
- Thunderstorm conditions appear in the hourly forecast beginning around Sun 12:00 AM.
- Overall operational environmental risk is HIGH. Primary concerns are wind, precipitation, thunderstorm.

Recommendations

- Confirm lightning monitoring, shelter, pause and evacuation procedures.
- Review temporary structures, signage and stage wind limits.
- Prepare drainage, electrical protection and wet-weather controls.
- Active Environment Canada alert(s) for the venue — review details: severe thunderstorm watch, wind warning.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: No need to modify your usual outdoor activities unless you experience symptoms such as coughing and throat irritation.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Consider reducing or rescheduling strenuous activities outdoors if you are experiencing symptoms.

Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: High Risk

AIR QUALITY
Moderate Risk
4.0 AQHI

HEAT
Low Risk
26.7 °C apparent/humidex

WIND
High Risk
77.4 km/h peak gust

PRECIPITATION
High Risk
5.9 mm/h maximum

THUNDERSTORM
High Risk
Sun 12:00 AM first forecast signal

WIND SHEAR
Low Risk
0.1 ° direction diff (10m vs 120m)

Local Monitoring

Nearest station 4.0 Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	Blended estimate 3.0 confidence High	PM2.5 (station) 34.3 µg/m³ Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	PM2.5 (community) 33.6 µg/m³ ACA_CloverdaleCL · 0.45 km
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Prepared by Alberta Capital Airshed for the Edmonton Folk Music Festival. Beta decision-support product — for the interactive map, live cameras and hourly outlook, scan the QR code or visit https://dkevinm.github.io/environmental_intelligence_edmonton/

